Regional Manager Guide: Deal Review, Escalation and Exception Management

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Access	Regional managers only
Status	draft for team review
Source	Team 1 authored fictional Marvel CPG document (fictional company documents are permitted by the capstone brief and the official client clarifications); review rules aligned with the negotiation simulator and the shared data platform; findings from the Team 1 V3 EDA

Marvel CPG is a fictional company created for the University at Buffalo CDA 650 capstone. This document was written by Team 1 for the project's RAG knowledge base. Figures marked data *come from the project dataset; everything else is fictional business content.*

Access: *regional managers only. The copilot must not return this document to field representative accounts.*

1 Purpose

This guide helps regional managers review discount proposals that need their decision, decide what to escalate, and find the stores and SKUs that need attention. It complements the pricing policy (MCPG-05), which representatives also use.

2 Reviewing a MANAGER OVERRIDE REQUIRED proposal

A proposal reaches you when the discount is above the account's cap, the gross margin is still at or above the minimum, and the account has offered the required execution commitment. Check, in this order:

1. **Margin.** Recalculate the gross margin on net price with the reference list price and unit cost (MCPG-05, section 3). If it is below the minimum, it is not an override case; it is a policy breach.
2. **The commitment matches the guardrail.** The commitment must be the one named for the channel and category (for example "+15% shelf share or 1 secondary display" for Modern Trade Laundry). "+15%" means 15 percentage points.
3. **The commitment can be verified.** Note the date of the latest audit for the store and SKU and what it showed (planogram, shelf share, secondary display). Agree when the next audit will confirm the commitment. Old audit evidence is not proof of current execution.
4. **Account context.** Look at the account's recent trade discount (28-day weighted), its stock position and its sell-in vs sell-out gap. Do not approve deeper discounts for an account that is already over-shipped.
5. **Record the decision** with the scenario's data version, date, inputs and outcome. A saved scenario is a record of the decision, not an approval in the shared data.

Past invoices are not precedent. Some historical invoices carry a source flag for exceeding a limit, and some exceed the cap without a flag. Treat these flags as history about that invoice, not as approval or rejection of a new proposal.

3 What to escalate above regional level

- **Any proposal below the minimum gross margin.** The simulator rejects it. A guardrail cannot be breached without senior commercial approval, which is outside the regional manager's authority.
- **Distributor proposals far above the cap.** Distributors negotiate volume, not shelf execution, so the shelf commitments in the guardrails rarely fit. Escalate unless the proposal is a planned volume deal (MCPG-07).
- **Repeated overrides for the same account** in a short period.

4 Finding exceptions

Use the dashboard with the KPI definitions in MCPG-08:

- **Tier 3 availability.** *(data)* Tier 3 accounts are out of stock on 15.1% of store-days and MSL compliant on only 11.0% of days. Their stock-outs are mostly a **reorder-timing** problem: orders are placed at a median of about 4 days of stock, 31% on an empty shelf, and 48% of restocks arrive after the shelf is already empty. Coach

representatives to agree reorder points with these stores.

- **Traditional Trade deliveries.** *(data)* 24% of Traditional Trade deliveries arrive late (Modern Trade 12%, Distributors 6.5%). Late deliveries explain only about 10% of stock-out days, so fixing ordering matters more than chasing logistics.
- **Planogram in small stores.** *(data)* Traditional Trade Tier 3 planogram compliance is about 53%, against 95% in Modern Trade Tier 1.
- **Data freshness.** Check coverage and the last reporting date before acting on a KPI. A store with several Unknown days needs a visit to confirm its real stock, not a conclusion from missing data.

5 Coaching points for representatives

- Sell availability first, then execution; quote only traceable figures (MCPG-03, section 1).
- Do not promise sales uplifts from displays or planogram compliance. The data does not show one larger than about 1%.
- Use the substitution guide (MCPG-02) as a stop-gap, and fix the reorder point as the real solution.
- Never present a proposal above the cap as agreed before your review.

6 Known data limitations to keep in mind

- **Execution uplift.** Marvel's data was described as including a sales uplift from secondary displays (+8%), planogram compliance (+5%) and shelf share (+3% per 10 points). Measured on the data, these effects are at most about 1%. Treat any execution uplift in the simulator as a labelled assumption.
- **Guardrail version.** The platform uses the retained guardrail table. A revised table with a separate standard discount (supplied 16 October 2026) is not approved yet.
- **Shelf share** is an allocation among Marvel's audited SKUs, not a share against competitors (MCPG-06, section 5).
- **Deliveries on unreported days.** About 8% of deliveries land on days the store did not report. They never appear in the reported stock, which simply carries on after the gap. Reported stock is reliable on reported days.
- **Traditional Trade sell-in gap** of about -45% persists even with matched windows (MCPG-08, section 3.3).

Document control

Item	Value
Document	MCPG-09, version 1.0.0
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Owner	Team 1 knowledge base (Sanika Najan)
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Source	Pricing policy MCPG-05 and the negotiation simulator status rules
Source	Shared V3 data platform (Module 3 guidance: guardrails 'Requires review'; source flags are historical evidence)
Source	Team 1 V3 EDA (notebook 01_v3_eda): sections 7, 8.2, 8.4, 8.6, 8.7, 8.8

Open points and review notes

- Approval levels above the regional manager are a team proposal based on the brief's definition of a commercial guardrail ('cannot be violated without senior approval'). The full approval decision tree is still an open decision.
- Permission scope 'manager': the retrieval layer must filter this document out for field representative sessions.